

Daily Cloud Security Brief

May 23, 2025

US indicts leader of Qakbot botnet linked to ransomware attacks

1. Summary: The United States has indicted Rustam Rafailevich Gallyamov, a Russian national, for leading the Qakbot botnet operation. This massive botnet, compromising over 700,000 computers worldwide, served as a crucial tool for facilitating widespread ransomware attacks. The indictment highlights a significant effort to dismantle a major cybercrime infrastructure.

Hackers use fake Ledger apps to steal Mac users' seed phrases

1. Summary: Hackers are distributing malicious applications disguised as legitimate Ledger cryptocurrency wallet software on macOS. These fake apps aim to steal users' seed phrases, the secret key that grants access to their cryptocurrency holdings. This allows criminals to gain control of and empty the victims' wallets.

Police arrests 270 dark web vendors, buyers in global crackdown

1. Summary: Operation RapTor, a multinational law enforcement operation, resulted in the arrest of 270 individuals across ten countries. These arrests targeted both vendors and buyers operating on the dark web.

Akamai, Microsoft Disagree on Severity of Unpatched 'BadSuccessor' Flaw

1. Summary: Akamai Technologies has publicly disclosed a privilege escalation vulnerability, dubbed "BadSuccessor," affecting Windows Server 2022. Microsoft has chosen not to immediately release a patch, leading to a disagreement between the two companies regarding the severity of the flaw.

Marlboro-Chesterfield Pathology Data Breach Impacts 235,000 People

1. Summary: Marlboro-Chesterfield Pathology experienced a data breach caused by the SafePay ransomware group. The attackers stole personal information from the pathology's systems.

Marks & Spencer Expects Ransomware Attack to Cost \$400 Million

1. Summary: Marks & Spencer (M&S), a major UK retailer, has been hit by a ransomware attack that is expected to cause significant disruption lasting into July. The company anticipates the attack will cost them approximately \$400 million.

Picus Launches Exposure Validation to Safely Deprioritize CVEs

Please provide the article content so I can summarize it for you in the requested format.

Following Data Breach, Multiple Stalkerware Apps Go Offline

1. Summary: Several stalkerware applications went offline following a data breach. The breach was attributed to a single, easily exploitable vulnerability present in at least three of the affected apps, allowing unauthorized access to user data.

Russian Threat Actor TAG-110 Goes Phishing in Tajikistan

1. Summary: The Russian threat actor group TAG-110 is conducting phishing campaigns in Tajikistan. This activity, while Ukraine remains a primary focus of Russian cyberattacks, demonstrates a broader Russian strategy to maintain influence within former Soviet republics by infiltrating their critical infrastructure.

Top 5 Takeaways

1. Ransomware remains a critical threat: The Qakbot indictment, Marks & Spencer's costly attack, and the Marlboro-Chesterfield breach highlight the persistent and devastating impact of ransomware, demanding robust preventative measures and incident response planning.
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3. Supply chain attacks are escalating: The Qakbot botnet's scale demonstrates the danger of compromised third-party vendors and the need for thorough vendor risk management programs.
- 4.

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5. 3. Phishing and malicious apps are highly effective: The fake Ledger app and the broader targeting of macOS users, along with the Tajikistan phishing campaign, underscore the ongoing effectiveness of sophisticated social engineering tactics. Invest in robust security awareness training.

6.

7. 4. Vulnerability patching discrepancies are dangerous: The disagreement between Akamai and Microsoft on the severity of the "BadSuccessor" flaw highlights the need for proactive patching and a robust vulnerability management program that prioritizes patching based on real-world risk assessment, not just vendor severity scores.

8.

9. 5. Dark web activity fuels cybercrime: Operation RapTor's arrests demonstrate the continuous need for collaboration between law enforcement and the private sector to disrupt dark web marketplaces and reduce the availability of stolen data and malicious tools.